

**DEPARTMENT OF APPLIED SCIENCES & HUMANITIES**

**Lecture Notes On**

**Technical Communication (BAS-301)**

**B.Tech. / 2<sup>nd</sup> Year / 3<sup>rd</sup> Sem.**

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### **C.V./ Résumé writing:**

CURRICULUM VITAE (C.V.): It is a Latin word which means 'Course of Life'. It represents the full academic history of an individual. It emphasizes academic accomplishment and achievement.

- 2.It is prepared for the fixed position.
- 3.It can be as long as required.
- 4.It is submitted to the fellow academics of one's field.
- 5.Reference can be the included part of it.

RÉSUMÉ: It is a French word which means 'Summary'. It provides the concise picture of an individual's skills & qualities. It emphasizes or highlights the skills.

- 2.It is prepared for the different job position or suitable for those who hire an individual for a wide variety of post.
3. It can be hardly one or two pages.
- 4.It is submitted to general employer who looks for multi-dimensional people (employee).
- 5.Reference is not required.

### **TYPES OF RÉSUMÉS:**

#### **Chronological Résumé**

The chronological **résumé** seems to be the most popular format used. They are straightforward and easy to scan. It contains a chronological listing (from most recent to the past) of all your employment along with related accomplishments. Education information is included along with certification and special skills.

Note: *A chronological résumé is particularly useful for people who:*

Have extensive, uninterrupted employment in the areas you are seeking employment

Format:

- o Lists positions in reverse chronological order (starting with the most recent and works backwards)
- o Job achievements and skills are listed under each position
- o Presents experience under headings by job title, company, location and dates of employment
- o Format allows employers to easily determine work performed at each company

#### **Disadvantages:**

- May be hard to communicate your skills and general strengths/qualities
- Emphasizes gaps in employment
- Dramatizes short-term employment
- Most dependent upon past experience

#### **Functional Résumé**

Functional **résumé** highlights your abilities rather than your chronological work history. Your skills are organized into categories. You'll still need to summarize your work history, but this is usually done at the bottom of your resume. By the time the reader has gotten to that point he/she is usually sold on bringing you in for an interview.

**Advantages: A functional résumé is particularly useful for people who:**

- Have gaps in their work history that they would like to minimize
- Are re-entering the workforce
- Have frequently changed jobs
- Are looking to transition into a new career

- Need to emphasize transferrable skills

Format:

- Focus is on skills and experience, rather than on chronological work history
- Responsibilities, accomplishments, and quantifiable achievements are described under each applicable heading
- Typically opens with a summary or profile detailing your, education and strengths or work history in 1-3 sentences
- Demonstrates how you ideally match the requirements of a particular job for which you are applying, by including relevant achievements and accomplishments

**Disadvantages:**

- Some employers are not accustomed to this format, and it can be confusing for employers to follow
- It tends to play down direct work experience with specific employers.

### **SEMINAR / CONFERENCE PAPER WRITING:**

A **Seminar** is a small group of students and teachers. A **seminar paper** is a record of what you say to the group about a topic you have studied. Preparing a seminar paper gives you practice in technical writing which will help you when you write your thesis.

**Conference papers** refer to articles that are written with the goal of being accepted to a conference: typically, an annual (or biannual) venue with a specific scope where you can present your results to the community, usually as an oral presentation, a poster presentation, or a tabled discussion. The review process for conference papers is typically within a fixed window: everyone submits for a certain deadline, then the review committee (program committee) collaborates to review and discuss papers, then all authors are notified with accept/reject at the same time. Since the review process has a fixed schedule (to meet the schedule of the physical meeting), conference review times are quite predictable.

**NOTE:**

- A. Conference papers are typically published in collections called "proceedings":
- B. Conference papers are often both a written document and an oral presentation.

### **Conference Paper Writing:**

There are several factors to consider as we get started on our conference paper writing.

- Sign up for e-mail for subfields and organizations you are interested in. Throughout the year you will get call-for-paper announcements offering panel discussions to be a part of.
- Pay attention to the deadline and guidelines. Read their panel description closely.
- Many conferences also accept individual papers. You submit your abstract and they will

place you with other presenters.

### **Write a strong abstract**

- Most conferences want you to participate (and want your conference fees payment), but they do have limits and criteria for accepting papers.
- You usually have 200-300 words to work with, so you don't have space to elaborate sophisticated concepts, nor to tell everything about your project.
- HAVE A POINT your paper will advance. Even if you don't yet know what that point is, make a concise and intelligible claim. Emphasize the innovative

### **Organizing the paper**

There are numerous ways to effectively organize a conference paper, but we should have a focused message that fits the time constraints and meets the needs of audience. We can begin by connecting research to the audience's concerns, then share a few examples/case studies from research, and then conclusion.

- ❑ A presentation is typically limited to 15 minutes. It takes roughly 2 minutes to read a double-spaced page of text. So, anything more than 7 or 8 pages is more than you can say in the presentation.
- ❑ Signal early on what your intentions with the paper are. Map out the argument so your audience can get a sense of what is to come.
- ❑ Write a data-driven essay. If you are a historian or literature scholar, delve into the primary texts. This will give your discussion a better chance at assessing your analytical points.
- ❑ Most importantly, you only have time in a presentation to develop ONE maybe two points. In any case, no one will remember more than two points, so keep it tight. It is always more effective to go in depth into one particular aspect of your research than try to sketch together many pieces in one showcase.

### **Citing sources**

Since conference paper will be part of an oral presentation, there are special considerations for citations. You should observe the conventions of your discipline with regard to including citations in your written paper.

### **Don't confuse your audience**

You should limit the information that you present. Don't attempt to summarize many details. Instead, try selecting main points and provide examples to support those points. Alternatively, you might focus on one main idea or case study and use 2-4 examples to explain it.

### **Check for clarity in the text**

One way to anticipate how your ideas will sound is to read your paper out loud. Reading out loud is an excellent proofreading technique and is a great way to check the clarity of your ideas. Help readers to understand your ideas by making sure that subjects and verbs are clear and by avoiding unnecessarily complex sentences.

### **Include verbal cues in the text**

- A. Use of transitional phrases like however, therefore, and thus, as well as signpost words like first, next, etc.
- B. If you have 5 main points enlist those 5 ideas. Refer back to this structure frequently as a transition between sections ("Now, I will discuss my fourth point, the importance of plasma").
- C. Use a phrase like "I argue" to announce thesis statement. Be sure that there is only one of these phrases—otherwise audience will be confused about your central message.
- D. Refer back to the structure, and signal moments where you are transitioning to a new topic: "I just talked about x, now I'm going to talk about y."

### **Prepare the presentation**

- ☐ To keep people's attention for the time you are talking. People generally stay more tuned in when they sense that someone is speaking to them, not reading to them. Some reduce their presentation to a series of points they talk through. This has the advantage of being "live".
- ☐ You might run out of time without a prepared text. Remember that by going overtime you are antagonizing your audience and colleagues on the panel.
- ☐ Be courteous.
- ☐ Practice reading your paper aloud for flow, emphasis, and timing. Replace unnecessary jargon or technical terms in speech. You want to be familiar enough with the writing that you can pick your head up and speak to people.
- ☐ Rules of PowerPoint (PPT): Your PPT slides should absolutely NOT replace your paper; i.e., you should
- ☐ not simply read bullet points and text excerpts off the screen to your audience.

### **At the event**

- ☐ If you are using audio-visual equipment, get to the room of your panel session early to test out the projector, software compatibility, etc.
- ☐ Listen to your co-presenters' talks and take notes. Show the same undivided attention and respect you would expect from others when you speak.
- ☐ Graciously thank the organizers and/or sponsors before you set off into your paper.
- ☐ A basic tenet of all public speaking: whether you are reading or not, look up from your paper regularly to make eye contact with the audience.

**EXPERT TECHNICAL LECTURE (E.T.L):** A lecture is an oral presentation intended to present information or teach people about a particular subject. Lectures are used to convey critical information theories and equation. Lectures delivered by an expert speaker can be highly effective. They are the experts in the field, informing the audience about the subject matter. These experts are the people who have a wide knowledge of the subject. It is a form of communication (convey scientific, engineering or other technical information with the help of an expert) in a professional or formal setting. It is delivered after research, observation, processing and analysis of topic. Modern/expert technical lectures incorporate writing, exercises, chalk, marker, board, question, answer session discussion or website etc. These lectures are simple in form and use technical style and language.

**Note:** These lectures may be delivered in a conference seminar, or in a workshop. There is certain pre-requisite which can make the lecture (E.T. L) more effective:

1. **Theme clarity:** lectures should be captivating and informative. Expert has to maintain a balance between all these in order to deliver a technical lecture successfully. The introduction section should set the theme and tone of the lecture. It should include all the points clearly so that the information can be conveyed.
2. **Analysis:** In order to make these lecture more captivating an expert has to analyze the detail available at that time. He/she can go for certain observation or research in order to collect fact, figure to prove his/ her point. Analysis of the information may make the theme clearer which will result in improved understanding.
3. **Finding:** These lectures should be prepared keeping the finding or some sort of result in mind so that desired effort can be made in order to achieve it.

## Writing the Statement of Purpose (SOP) for Admission in Higher Studies

### Introduction:

- The Statement of Purpose (SOP) is a crucial component of your application for higher studies. It's your opportunity to articulate your goals, experiences, and reasons for pursuing a specific program or degree. This lecture focuses on mastering the art of crafting an effective SOP that can significantly impact your chances of admission.

### I. Understanding the SOP:

#### A. Definition and Purpose:

1. An SOP or a Statement of Purpose is a letter written by the applicant conveying their intent for choosing a particular course, their interests, goals and career plans. It is addressed to the admission committee. It is also known as a research statement or a letter of intent.

#### B. Importance of the SOP:

1. Differentiation: Helps you stand out among applicants with similar qualifications.
2. Showcasing Fit: Demonstrates that you are a good fit for the program.
3. Personalization: Allows you to convey your personality and unique story.

### II. Structuring Your SOP:

#### A. Introduction:

1. **Hook the Reader:** Begin with an engaging anecdote or a compelling introduction to grab the reader's attention.
2. **State Your Purpose:** Clearly state your intent for pursuing higher studies.

#### B. Educational Background:

1. **Academic Journey:** Highlight your academic achievements, including degrees, GPA, and relevant coursework.
2. **Relevant Experience:** Mention any research, projects, or internships that are pertinent to your field of study.

#### C. Professional Experience (if applicable):

- Discuss any work experience and how it has contributed to your decision to pursue higher studies.

#### D. Research Interests (if applicable):

- If you're applying for research-based programs, outline your research interests and how they align with the program's offerings.

#### E. Program Specifics:

- Explain why you're interested in the specific program or institution. Discuss faculty members, courses, or facilities that attract you.

#### F. Career Goals:

1. **Short-Term Goals:** Describe your immediate career objectives upon completing the program.
2. **Long-Term Goals:** Explain your long-term aspirations and how the program contributes to them.

#### G. Personal Motivation:

- Share personal motivations, experiences, or events that have shaped your decision to pursue higher studies.

#### H. Conclusion:

1. **Summarize:** Recap the key points of your SOP.
2. **Future Outlook:** Express your enthusiasm for the program and your optimism for the future.

### III. Writing Tips for an Effective SOP:

A. **Clarity and Conciseness:** Be clear and concise in your writing. Admissions committees often have many SOPs to review.

B. **Professional Tone:** Maintain a professional, formal tone throughout the document.

C. **Show, Don't Tell:** Instead of stating qualities, demonstrate them through examples and experiences.

D. **Avoid Clichés:** Avoid overused phrases and clichés; be original in your writing.

E. **Proofread and Edit:** Carefully proofread your SOP for grammar, spelling, and coherence. Consider seeking feedback from peers or mentors.

F. **Be Honest:** Present an authentic picture of yourself. Exaggeration or falsehoods can harm your application.

G. **Tailor Each SOP:** Customize your SOP for each program and institution. Highlight what makes each one a great fit for your goals.

### IV. Ethical Considerations:

A. **Plagiarism:** Never plagiarize content from other sources. Your SOP should be your unique work.

B. **Honesty:** Be honest about your qualifications, experiences, and intentions.

C. **Respect Word Limits:** Adhere to word or page limits set by the institution.

### Conclusion:

Writing an effective Statement of Purpose is a critical step in the admission process for higher studies. It's an opportunity to present yourself, your qualifications, and your aspirations to the admissions committee. By following the structure and tips discussed in this lecture, you can create a compelling SOP that increases your chances of securing admission in your chosen program. Remember that honesty, clarity, and personalization are key to crafting an impactful SOP.

## *What makes a good SOP?*

- It Should be original. There are plenty of sample SOPs available on the internet and it is not advisable to copy them verbatim.
- Your Statement of Purpose should be free of grammatical errors
- Your SOP should have answers to some crucial questions that the admission committee might have about you.
- If the institution has requested the SOP in a particular format, make sure you follow it.
- A good SOP will demonstrate your passion for the subject, your potential and your purpose for choosing the particular course.

## *The Dos: Tips for writing a good SOP or Statement of Purpose*

1. Font style and size are vital while drafting an SOP. These are often missed or not followed by students while drafting an SOP.
2. Write your SOP in the active voice and let it have a positive feel altogether.
3. The SOP should have a formal tone, but keep it conversational.
4. It should have continuity.
5. Follow the instructions, if any, given by the institution. For example, you might be asked to limit your SOP to one page.
6. Use examples in your SOP to garner the attention of the reader. These will stand out more than generic statements.
7. Keep editing and rewriting, till the last date you send it across. The more you edit, the better your work becomes. If you are running out of words, let the draft sit in one corner for a few days, and then get back to it with a fresh mind.
8. Your SOP should be tweaked based on the institution or course that you are applying to.

## *The Don'ts: Common mistakes to avoid while writing an SOP*

1.        Avoid using commonly used adjectives while writing an SOP. For example, hard-working and challenging
2.        Do not make vague and generic statements. It should be followed by specific instances from your life.
3.        Do not repeat the information in your SOP. Also if you have mentioned something in your resume, please do not copy-paste or repeat it in your SOP. Let the information in your resume be distinct from that in your SOP.
4.        It is difficult to pull off humor and sarcasm in writing. Hence, it is safe to stay clear of those.
5.        Most importantly, never copy anyone's SOP and share it as your own. There are tools that can catch plagiarism, which is a serious offence.
6.        Though your confident persona should show through the SOP, make sure you won't be mistaken as an arrogant and self-obsessed person.
7.        Do not draw attention to your drawback or failures, unless you highlight that those were your learning experiences and you did something about it.
8.        Do not include information that is not necessary or relevant to your college education.